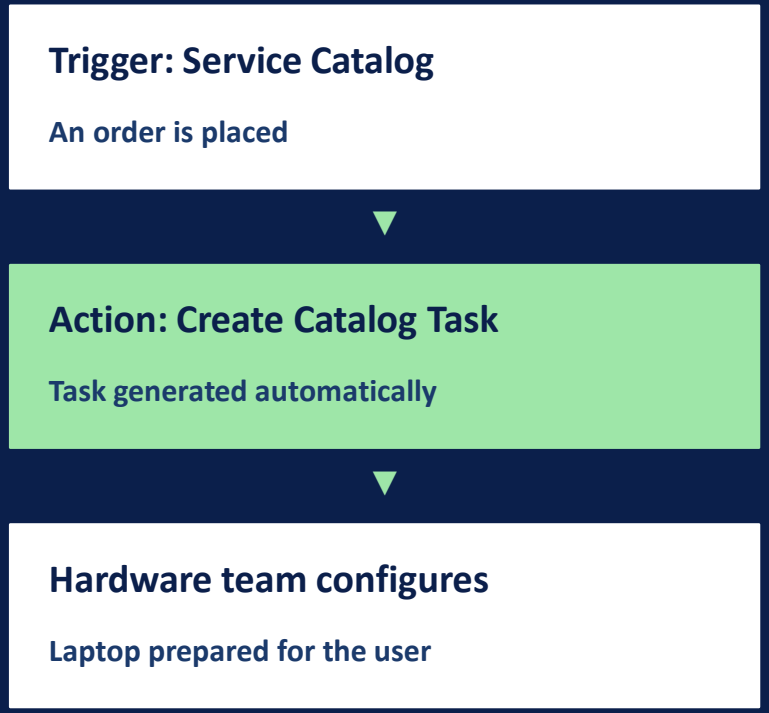
IT PROCUREMENT AUTOMATION

Streamlining IT Procurement

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer. A catalog order now creates and assigns a configuration task with no manual hand-off.



ServiceNow | Smart Internz | SmartBridge

WHY THIS PROJECT

Problem Statement

Delays and manual overhead in standard laptop orders

Every standard request needs someone to notice it, raise the work and chase it, even though the request is identical each time.

1. **Manual handling**
   Standard laptop requests lack efficiency and automation. Staff re-key the same details and forward work by hand.

2. **Configuration gaps**
   The configuration step is prone to oversight or delay, as nothing guarantees the hardware team is told in time.

3. **Frustration and waste**
   Users wait longer for devices and skilled IT time goes on repetitive admin instead of higher-value work.

WHO BENEFITS

User Story

AS A

Member of the IT procurement team, responsible for getting approved hardware requests fulfilled quickly and consistently.

I WANT

A streamlined process for ordering standard laptops, with tasks automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team without anyone raising them manually.

SO THAT

Laptops are promptly configured on arrival, reducing user wait times and manual intervention, and the team can focus on exceptions.

WHAT WE AIM TO ACHIEVE

Project Objectives

1

Seamless user experience

Timely configuration for users requesting standard laptops, so devices are ready when they arrive.

2

Less manual work

Reduce manual intervention and potential errors by letting the platform create and route tasks.

3

Better resource use

Optimise task allocation within the IT department so the right team is always assigned.

4

Higher productivity

Improve overall efficiency of IT procurement operations and free staff for higher-value work.

MILESTONE 1 | ACTIVITY 1

Create the Flow

Flow properties

FLOW NAME

Standard laptop task

APPLICATION

Global

RUN AS

System User

TRIGGER

Service Catalog

1. **Open Flow Designer**
   In ServiceNow go to All > Flow Designer (Process Automation).
2. **Start a new flow**
   Click New > Flow.
3. **Enter the flow properties**
   Fill in the values shown on the left and click Submit.
4. **Add a trigger**
   Click Add a trigger to define what starts the flow.
5. **Select Service Catalog**
   Search for Service Catalog and select it as the trigger.
6. **Confirm the trigger**
   Click Done to save the trigger configuration.

Action: Create Catalog Task

Field	Value
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request Item	Drag the Requested Item record from the trigger
Table	Catalog Task [sc_task] (auto-populated)
Short description	Laptop needs to be configured
Description	Laptop needs to be configured
Assignment group	Hardware (the team that will do the work)
Approval	Approved

Tip: dragging the Requested Item from the trigger links each task to the order that created it.

1 Click Done

Keep the remaining fields as default.

2 Save the flow

Click Save to store your changes.

3 Activate

Click Activate, then confirm Activate so the flow can run.

MILESTONE 2 | ACTIVITY 1

Flow Assignment to the Catalog Item

1

Open Maintain Items

Go to All, search Maintain Items and select it.

2

Find the item

Search the Name field for Standard Laptop and open the record.

3

Process Engine tab

Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.

4

Attach the flow

Select Standard laptop task, then save the record.

Result: ordering a Standard Laptop now triggers the Standard laptop task flow automatically.

MILESTONE 3 | ACTIVITY 1

Place the Order in Service Catalog

1. **Open Service Catalog**
   Click All and search for Service Catalog.

2. **Browse Hardware**
   Open Service Catalog > Hardware.

3. **Open Standard Laptop**
   Scroll to Standard Laptop and open the item.

4. **Order Now**
   Review the specification, then click Order Now to place the request.

5. **Note the Request Number**
   On Order Status, record the Request Number for later.

Standard Laptop

Lenovo Carbon X1

- Intel Core i5 processor
- 512GB SSD
- Backlit keyboard

Optional: Adobe Acrobat, Adobe Photoshop

Order Now

MILESTONE 3 | ACTIVITY 1

Approve and Verify the Task

1. **Open the Request Number**
   Use the number noted at order time.
2. **Open the Approvers tab**
   Scroll down to find it.
3. **Approve the request**
   Right-click the record and choose Approve.
4. **Open the Requested Items tab**
   Then open the RITM.
5. **Find Catalog Tasks**
   Scroll to the Catalog Tasks section.
6. **Verify the task**
   Open it and confirm the details match.

Catalog Task created

NUMBER
SCTASK0010001

SHORT DESCRIPTION
Laptop needs to be configured

ASSIGNMENT GROUP
Hardware

APPROVAL
Approved

CONCLUSION

Automation That Works for Everyone

Timely

Laptops are configured promptly, cutting user wait times from request to ready device.

Efficient

Less manual overhead and fewer errors for IT, with work routed to Hardware automatically.

Seamless

Optimised task allocation and a better experience for requesters and the IT team alike.

Flow Designer turns standard laptop procurement into a faster, error-free process.